

Sarpech

Date unknown

The extraordinary wealth of the Mughals was evident in their love of jeweled objects. This *sarpech*, made of gold, emeralds, diamonds, rubies, and a pearl, adorned a royal turban.

large ruby at center

solid jade pestle

spike can be used as weapon

Mortar and pestle

17th century
Jade could only be worked using diamond dust, so it was highly prized in Mughal society. This mortar and pestle was carved from one block.

Hansli necklace

18th century

Cast in gold and heavily encrusted with precious stones, this rigid torque or necklace was known as a *hansli*, because it was designed to rest on the wearer's collarbone—or *hansli* in Urdu.

floral pattern shows through

Bowl inlaid with jade

18th century
Parchin kârî, or inlay, reached its peak during the reign of Jahan (1628–58). This bowl is inlaid with jade and precious stones.

Enameled gold wine goblet

17th century
Records of Mughal courtly life describe kings sipping their wine from enameled gold or silver goblets, and dozens of dishes served on gold and silver plates.

engraving of a dancing girl

bowl for holding tobacco

deer motif

water jar or bowl

golden base

silver incised hookah bowl



Mughal court painting

17th century
The splendor of the Mughal court is clear from this painting of the emperor Jahan (r. 1628–58) among his nobles, grouped in strict hierarchical order around the throne.

Jahan, fifth Mughal emperor

Hookahs

18th century

The Mughals brought the Persian tradition of hookah-smoking to India. Both men and women used hookahs, in which tobacco smoke is cooled with water.

Talisman

Date unknown

Mughal craftsmen were famed for the intricacy of their work. This talisman, or *tabeez*, is decorated with verses from the Qur'an.

enameled floral motif